Prem Seetharaman

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Research interests

Lowering the barrier to entry for creative work in video and audio by leveraging and developing state-of-the-art generative modeling techniques. My research interests are primarily in computer audition, with a focus on generative audio modeling (e.g. speech synthesis, music generation), audio representation learning, audio compression, and audio-to-audio mapping (e.g. speech/music separation and enhancement).

Education

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL
09/2019 - PhD, Computer Science

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL
BS, Computer Science, Music Composition - 2013

Professional employment

Adobe Research
Sr. Research Scientist: 2023 - Present

- Generate Soundscape in Adobe Premiere (beta) - picture-synced soundscapes for video, based on our MultiFoley research.
  https://community.adobe.com/announcements-732/now-in-beta-generate-soundscape-in-premiere-1639274
- Generate Sound Effects in Adobe Firefly (beta) - sound effects from text and vocal imitation, based on our Sketch2Sound research.
  https://helpx.adobe.com/firefly/web/work-with-audio-and-video/work-with-audio/voice-to-sound-effects.html
- Contributed to Adobe MAX Sneaks: Project Super Sonic (2024) and Project Sound Stager (2025).

Descript, Inc.
Research Scientist: 2020 - 2023

- Led Studio Sound - state-of-the-art speech enhancement.
  https://www.descript.com/studio-sound
- Core contributor to Overdub - voice cloning for speech editing.
  https://www.descript.com/overdub
- Developed the Descript Audio Codec - high-fidelity audio compression, which powers internal audio language models for editing speech and generating music.
  https://github.com/descriptinc/descript-audio-codec

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL
Postdoctoral Scholar: 2019 - 2020

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL
Doctoral Student in Interactive Audio Lab: 2013 - 2019

Mitsubishi Electric Research Labs, Cambridge, MA
Research Intern: 2018

Adobe Research, San Francisco, CA
Research Intern: 2017-2018

Gracenote, Emeryville, CA
Research Intern: 2016

Publications

Thesis

[1] **Seetharaman, Prem**. "Bootstrapping the Learning Process for Computer Audition". PhD thesis. Northwestern University, 2019.

Patents

[1] Prem Seetharaman, Oriol Nieto, and Justin Salamon. *Generative Audio Extension*. US Patent App. 18/916,334. 2026.

[2] Justin Salamon, Prem Seetharaman, Oriol Nieto, Hugo Flores García, et al. *Generative Sound Effects for Video Editing*. US Patent App. 18/916,465. 2026.

[3] Prem Seetharaman and Kundan Kumar. *Training Machine Learning Frameworks to Generate Studio-Quality Recordings Through Manipulation of Noisy Audio Signals*. US Patent 12,431,154. 2025.

[4] Zafar Rafii and Prem Seetharaman. *Audio Identification Based on Data Structure*. US Patent 12,105,754. 2024.

[5] Prem Seetharaman and Kundan Kumar. *Approaches to Generating Studio-Quality Recordings Through Manipulation of Noisy Audio*. US Patent App. 18/154,718. July 2023.

[6] Prem Seetharaman, Gautham J Mysore, and Bryan A Pardo. *Sound Quality Prediction and Interface to Facilitate High-Quality Voice Recordings*. US Patent App. 16/296,122. Sept. 2020.

[7] Markus K Cremer, Zafar Rafii, Robert Coover, and Prem Seetharaman. *Automated Cover Song Identification*. US Patent App. 15/698,557. July 2018.

Journal Articles

[1] Vivian Tang, Prem Seetharaman, Kevin Chao, Bryan A Pardo, and Suzan Van Der Lee. "Automating the detection of dynamically triggered earthquakes via a deep metric learning algorithm". In: *Seismological Research Letters* 91.2A (2020), pp. 901–912.

[2] Bryan Pardo, Mark Cartwright, Prem Seetharaman, and Bongjun Kim. "Learning to build natural audio production interfaces". In: *Arts*. Vol. 8. 3. MDPI. 2019, p. 110.

[3] Eric J Humphrey, Sravana Reddy, Prem Seetharaman, Aparna Kumar, Rachel M Bittner, Andrew Demetriou, Sankalp Gulati, Andreas Jansson, Tristan Jehan, Bernhard Lehner, et al. "An introduction to signal processing for singing-voice analysis: High notes in the effort to automate the understanding of vocals in music". In: *IEEE Signal Processing Magazine* 36.1 (2018), pp. 82–94.

[4] Prem Seetharaman and Bryan Pardo. "Audealize: Crowdsourced Audio Production Tools". In: *Journal of the Audio Engineering Society* 64.9 (2016), pp. 683–695.

Papers

[1] Sonal Kumar, Prem Seetharaman, Ke Chen, Oriol Nieto, Jiaqi Su, Zhepei Wang, Rithesh Kumar, Dinesh Manocha, Nicholas J. Bryan, Zeyu Jin, and Justin Salamon. "TAC: Timestamped Audio Captioning". In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. 2026.

[2] Annie Chu, Hugo Flores García, Johannes Imort, Oriol Nieto, Bryan Pardo, Jordan Rudess, Prem Seetharaman, and Justin Salamon. "Smorph: Playable Sound Morphing with Diffusion Models". In: *Proceedings of the 27th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference*. 2026.

[3] Ashish Seth, Sonal Kumar, Ramaneswaran Selvakumar, Nishit Anand, Utkarsh Tyagi, Prem Seetharaman, Ramani Duraiswami, and Dinesh Manocha. "Audio Hallucination Attacks: Probing the Reliability of Large Audio Language Models". In: *Proceedings of Interspeech*. 2026.

[4] William Chen, Prem Seetharaman, Rithesh Kumar, Oriol Nieto, Shinji Watanabe, Justin Salamon, and Zeyu Jin. "AudioChat: Unified Audio Storytelling, Editing, and Understanding with Transfusion Forcing". In: *Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*. 2026.

[5] Prem Seetharaman and Rithesh Kumar. "Taming Audio VAEs via Target-KL Regularization". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2026.

[6] Prem Seetharaman, Oriol Nieto, and Justin Salamon. "Generative Audio Extension and Morphing". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2026.

[7] Annie Chu, Hugo Flores García, Oriol Nieto, Justin Salamon, Bryan Pardo, and Prem Seetharaman. "Mix2Morph: Learning Sound Morphing from Noisy Mixes". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2026.

[8] Sripathi Sridhar, Prem Seetharaman, Oriol Nieto, Mark Cartwright, and Justin Salamon. "AudioCards: Structured Metadata Improves Audio Language Models for Sound Design". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2026.

[9] Yutong Wen, Ke Chen, Prem Seetharaman, Oriol Nieto, Jiaqi Su, Rithesh Kumar, Minje Kim, Paris Smaragdis, Zeyu Jin, and Justin Salamon. "PromptSep: Generative Audio Separation via Multimodal Prompting". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2026.

[10] Jialin Huang, Prem Seetharaman, Tim Langlois, Li-Yi Wei, Rubaiat Habib Kazi, and Yotam Gingold. "MoSound: An Interactive Tool for Generative Sound Design in Motion Graphics". In: *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2026. **Best Paper Honorable Mention**.

[11] Suhyeon Yoo, Adolfo Hernandez Santisteban, Prem Seetharaman, Justin Salamon, Oriol Nieto, and Anh Truong. "SoundStager: Interactive Design of Story-Driven GenAI Soundscapes for Video". In: *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2026.

[12] Patrick O'Reilly, Julia Barnett, Hugo Flores García, Annie Chu, Nathan Pruyne, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "The Rhythm In Anything: Audio-Prompted Drums Generation with Masked Language Modeling". In: *Proceedings of the 26th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference*. 2025.

[13] Sonal Kumar, Prem Seetharaman, Justin Salamon, Dinesh Manocha, and Oriol Nieto. "SILA: Signal-to-Language Augmentation for Enhanced Control in Text-to-Audio Generation". In: *IEEE Workshop on Applications of Signal Processing to Audio and Acoustics (WASPAA)*. 2025.

[14] Yusong Wu, Christos Tsirigotis, Ke Chen, Cheng-Zhi Anna Huang, Aaron Courville, Oriol Nieto, Prem Seetharaman, and Justin Salamon. "FLAM: Frame-Wise Language-Audio Modeling". In: *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*. 2025.

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[16] Hugo Flores García, Oriol Nieto, Justin Salamon, Bryan Pardo, and Prem Seetharaman. "Sketch2Sound: Controllable Audio Generation via Time-Varying Signals and Sonic Imitations". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2025.

[17] Patrick O'Reilly, Prem Seetharaman, Jiaqi Su, Zeyu Jin, and Bryan Pardo. "Code Drift: Towards Idempotent Neural Audio Codecs". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. 2025.

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[19] Rithesh Kumar, Prem Seetharaman, Alejandro Luebs, Ishaan Kumar, and Kundan Kumar. "High-Fidelity Audio Compression with Improved RVQGAN". In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. 2023.

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[30] Nicolas Turpault, Scott Wisdom, Hakan Erdogan, John R Hershey, Romain Serizel, Eduardo Fonseca, Prem Seetharaman, and Justin Salamon. "Improving Sound Event Detection In Domestic Environments Using Sound Separation". In: *DCASE Workshop-Detection and Classification of Acoustic Scenes and Events 2020*. 2020.

[31] Alisa Liu, Alexander Fang, Gaëtan Hadjeres, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "Incorporating Music Knowledge in Continual Dataset Augmentation for Music Generation". In: *ML4MD Workshop at ICML 2020*. 2020.

[32] Alexander Fang, Alisa Liu, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "Bach or mock? a grading function for chorales in the style of JS Bach". In: *ML4MD Workshop at ICML 2020*. 2020.

[33] Prem Seetharaman, Gordon Wichern, Jonathan Le Roux, and Bryan Pardo. "Bootstrapping unsupervised deep music separation from primitive auditory grouping principles". In: *ICML 2020 Workshop on Self-supervision in Audio and Speech*. 2020.

[34] Ethan Manilow, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "Simultaneous separation and transcription of mixtures with multiple polyphonic and percussive instruments". In: *ICASSP 2020-2020 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. IEEE. 2020, pp. 771–775.

[35] Fatemeh Pishdadian, Bongjun Kim, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "Classifying Non-Speech Vocals: Deep vs Signal Processing Representations". In: 2019.

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[37] Prem Seetharaman. "Bootstrapping the Learning Process for Computer Audition". PhD thesis. Northwestern University, 2019.

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[41] Prem Seetharaman, Gordon Wichern, Jonathan Le Roux, and Bryan Pardo. "Bootstrapping Single-Channel Source Separation via Unsupervised Spatial Clustering on Stereo Mixtures". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP), 2019*. 2018.

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[43] Julia Wilkins, Prem Seetharaman, Alison Wahl, and Bryan Pardo. "VocalSet: A Singing Voice Dataset". In: *Proceedings of the 19th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference*. 2018.

[44] Prem Seetharaman, Gautham J Mysore, Paris Smaragdis, and Bryan Pardo. "Blind Estimation of the Speech Transmission Index for Speech Quality Prediction". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP), 2018*. 2018.

[45] Prem Seetharaman, Fatemeh Pishdadian, and Bryan Pardo. "Music/Voice Separation Using the 2D Fourier Transform". In: *IEEE Workshop on Applications of Signal Processing to Audio and Acoustics*. 2017.

[46] Ethan Manilow, Prem Seetharaman, Fatemeh Pishdadian, and Bryan Pardo. "Predicting Algorithm Efficacy for Adaptive Multi-Cue Source Separation". In: *IEEE Workshop on Applications of Signal Processing to Audio and Acoustics*. 2017.

[47] Prem Seetharaman and Zafar Rafii. "Cover Song Identification with 2D Fourier Transform Sequences". In: *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP), 2017*. 2017.

[48] Taylor Zheng, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "SocialFX: Studying a Crowdsourced Folksonomy of Audio Effects Terms". In: *Proceedings of the 2016 ACM on Multimedia Conference*. ACM. 2016, pp. 182–186.

[49] Prem Seetharaman and Bryan Pardo. "Simultaneous Separation and Segmentation in Layered Music". In: *Proceedings of the 17th International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference*. 2016, pp. 495–502.

[50] Prem Seetharaman and Bryan Pardo. "Crowdsourcing a Reverberation Descriptor Map". In: *Proceedings of the 22nd ACM international conference on Multimedia*. ACM. 2014, pp. 587–596.

[51] Prem Seetharaman and Stephen P Tarzia. "The Hand Clap as an Impulse Source for Measuring Room Acoustics". In: *Audio Engineering Society Convention 132*. Audio Engineering Society. 2012.

Preprints

[1] William Chen, Prem Seetharaman, Ke Chen, Oriol Nieto, Kevin Duarte, Siddharth Srinivasan Iyer, Mamshad Nayeem Rizve, Zhiwen Cao, Shinji Watanabe, Yuanjun Xiong, Jianming Zhang, Zeyu Jin, and Justin Salamon. "CrossEdit: Cross-Modal Training Enables Rich Audio-Visual Editing". In: *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.10264* (2026).

Extended Abstracts

[1] Vivian Tang, Prem Seetharaman, Kevin Chao, Bryan A Pardo, and Suzan van der Lee. "Siamese networks for triggered earthquakes detection". In: *AGU Fall Meeting Abstracts*. Vol. 2018. 2018, S11E–0428.

[2] Kevin Chao, Prem Seetharaman, Vivian Tang, Bryan A Pardo, and Suzan Van der Lee. "Automatic classification of triggered tectonic tremor with deep learning". In: *AGU Fall Meeting Abstracts*. Vol. 2018. 2018, T33E–0463.

[3] Prem Seetharaman and Bryan Pardo. "Reverbalize: A Crowdsourced Reverberation Controller". In: *Proceedings of the 22nd ACM international conference on Multimedia*. ACM. 2014, pp. 739–740.

[4] Michael Donovan, Prem Seetharaman, and Bryan Pardo. "A Web Audio Node for the Fast Creation of Natural Language Interfaces for Audio Production". In: (2017).

References

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